

GA-CM-01

Family Communication & Professional Boundaries

Warm, accurate, student-centred communication through approved channels and appropriate professional relationships.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Gardner Academy staff standard

01 Policy statement

Families and staff are partners in a child's learning. Communication must be warm, clear, factual, respectful, and centred on the student while preserving privacy and professional boundaries.

02 Communication standard

Every communication with a parent or family is made as a representative of Gardner Academy and never in a personal capacity. Staff should greet personally, begin with useful context, explain the relevant information clearly, return the conversation to the student's needs, and close with a practical next step. Communication should be constructive about the school and encourage its efforts. When unsure, ask internally rather than guessing on behalf of Gardner.

03 Approved practice

Staff must:

- Use school-approved channels, accounts, groups, and recordkeeping processes.
- Share factual observations and distinguish them from interpretation or diagnosis.
- Refer policy, fee, placement, medical, safeguarding, and employment questions to the authorised person.
- Keep communication courteous and school-focused even when a family is upset or disagrees.
- Raise personal frustration, disagreement, or discontent through internal supervision, management, grievance, or safeguarding channels and never discuss it with parents.
- Record significant concerns, commitments, or decisions through the approved process.

04 Professional boundaries

Staff must not use school relationships to solicit personal business, loans, donations, favours, or private arrangements. Personal contact details, private social-media relationships, gifts, and one-to-one communication with students must follow the applicable school policy and approved communication process.

05 Escalation and privacy

Move sensitive discussions away from students and public areas. A complaint, conflict, safety concern, or request outside the staff member's authority must be referred promptly to the appropriate manager. Share only information the recipient is authorised to receive.